Mobile UX Prototyping, UXD-M
Exercise, Winter term 2026/27

Exercise Sheet 01
Prof. Dr. Simon Nestler

Claims and their sources · Patterns as a language

What is this sheet about?

This sheet brings together the two topics that open the term: *Claims and their sources* and *Patterns as a language*. You apply both to one and the same app from this week's top charts – first to the market claims that surround it, then to the patterns inside it. Every claim is hunted back to its oldest reachable source, and every pattern verdict names its price.

Everything you need for the pattern half is on this sheet: the definition, the four families with their core patterns, the reference works and the three legitimate reasons to break a pattern. The MUXP.1 group works this sheet *before* the lecture on *Patterns as a language*, so nothing here assumes that session.

Organisation: Work in teams of three, four only if the numbers do not divide. In the pattern dissection, each of you takes one pattern family: navigation, forms and feedback in a team of three, plus search in a team of four.

On this sheet, the letters A, B, C and D stand for the pattern families. Settle who carries which letter before the first assignment; a team of three has no D and leaves search out.

What you take with you: At the end of the session, **every person** holds a claim check (assignment 2) and a dissection of the family or families they took (assignment 3) of their own. The team writes the synthesis (assignment 4) once, and every member keeps a copy. The sheet has no upload of its own. Its results are the content of **Part A**, your first graded presentation (see the end of this sheet); they count again in **Part C**, and they go into your **seminar paper**.

First assignment (15 minutes): Choose your target app from the list announced in the session (taken from this week's top charts). The letters correspond to the four pattern families: (A) *navigation*, (B) *forms*, (C) *feedback*, (D) *search*.

Then collect the claims that surround your app: open its App Store or Play Store page, the vendor's press section and one aggregator article about the app or its market. Collect at least four market claims as verbatim quotes (with where you found them). You will need them in the second assignment, so do not judge them yet.

Second assignment (45 minutes): Each team member picks *one* of the collected market claims (each member a different one) and performs a complete claim check.

- **The claim,** quoted verbatim, with where you found it.
- **The source chain:** hunt the claim to the oldest origin you can reach. Note every station (primary source, secondary use, aggregator) with year and publisher.
- **Your verdict** (*supported / supportable / unsupportable*), argued with the three-part criterion from Topic 1: measurer, year, population. A verdict of *"plausible"* does not count.
- **The flip condition:** *"My verdict changes if …"* One sentence that a concrete finding could actually falsify, as in the *Label the claim* activity of Topic 1.

AI role: tool. Models are allowed and encouraged for the source hunt. Note what you asked, and watch what they hand you as *"sources"*: that observation is part of the exercise.

Pattern vocabulary for this sheet

A pattern is a named, recurring solution to a recurring design problem – proven by use, not by argument. The name lets a team argue about a screen instead of pointing at it. *Recurring* means that problem and solution return across thousands of apps; a trick used in a single app gets no name. And *proven by use* is what separates a pattern from a style guide, which justifies its rules on paper, and from taste.

Where pattern names come from. Four reference works, and you name which one you used:

- **Tidwell**, *Designing Interfaces* – the classic catalogue of interface patterns with established names.
- **Apple Human Interface Guidelines (HIG)** – Apple's platform contract, and the naming authority for iOS.
- **Material 3** – Google's platform contract, and the naming authority for Android.
- **Mobbin** – a collection of current app screens, sorted into categories; useful where the two platform contracts have no term.

The four families and their core patterns. These are the patterns you will most often find; the list is not exhaustive, and a pattern outside it is a legitimate answer if you name its source.

- **(A) Navigation** – *tab bar* (everything visible, at most five destinations, paid for in screen space), *navigation drawer* (hides and scales: room for twenty entries, at the price that nobody sees them), *hub & spoke* (every route through the center: clean separation, slow switching), *sequential flow* (one step at a time, the shape of checkout and onboarding).
- **(B) Forms** – *inline validation* (the form checks each field while you type, and the error appears where it happens), *input-appropriate keyboards* (a number field opens the number pad), *progressive disclosure* (ask later what you do not need now).
- **(C) Feedback** – *optimistic UI* (acts as if it worked and repairs if it did not: the message shows as sent before the server confirms), *skeleton screens* (show the shape of what is coming; a gray placeholder feels faster than a spinner over nothing), *undo over confirm* (act first, offer reversal, skip the "Are you sure?" – but only where reversal is actually possible), *error messages* in plain language that name the problem and suggest a way out, on the screen rather than in a modal.
- **(D) Search** – *type-ahead* (suggests while the user is still typing, because steering a query beats repairing one), *scoped search* (search where the user already stands before searching everything), *zero-results recovery* (an empty list is a dead end; a good zero state loosens the filter, fixes the typo, offers the neighbour category).

Mobile UX Prototyping, UXD-M
Exercise, Winter term 2026/27

Exercise Sheet 01
Prof. Dr. Simon Nestler

Pattern cards from Topic 2. The appendix of this sheet holds twelve screens of real apps from the Topic 2 lecture, every family at least twice, with the answer key behind them. Name the cards first, then check your naming against the key; the two contestable cards show where search, filter and navigation overlap.

The three legitimate reasons to break a pattern – and there is no fourth. Every legitimate break points to something that changed: the device, the gesture, or the message.

1. **A new device class** where the pattern never fitted – smartwatch navigation could not inherit the tab bar.
2. **A new gesture or capability** that makes a pattern obsolete – system-wide swipe gestures demoted the back button.
3. **Deliberate contrast**, the rarest and riskiest reason: the break *is* the message.

The fourth reason, the one that is not legitimate, is that nobody thought about it – and from outside that can look exactly like courage. The difference shows in the price: whoever broke a pattern without thinking cannot name what it cost.

Third assignment (60 minutes): Now turn to the patterns inside the app. Each team member dissects the pattern family they took by operating the app on a device; screenshots only document what you found: (A) navigation, (B) forms, (C) feedback, (D) search.

Start from the guiding question of your family (or of each of your two):

– **(A) Navigation:** how well does the navigation support orientation, consistency and efficient movement within the app?
– **(B) Forms:** how simple and logical are the forms in layout, validation and error prevention? Look for duplicated fields, password rules shown only after a failed attempt, and placeholders that disappear while the user types.
– **(C) Feedback:** how clear is the feedback in errors, confirmations and progress? An error message names the problem in plain language, suggests a way out and appears on the screen where the problem is.
– **(D) Search:** how relevant are the results, and do filters and suggestions help?

For each family you took, document:

– **The dominant pattern,** named with a Tidwell term, an HIG or Material 3 term, or a Mobbin category – see the vocabulary above. State which source you used.
– **One recognition feature:** *"I recognize it by …"* in one sentence.
– **One deviation,** if any: where does the app break the established pattern? Give your verdict (*innovation / error*) **and its price**, one sentence each. Check the verdict against the three legitimate reasons listed above: a new device class, a new gesture or capability, deliberate contrast. If none of them applies, say so – that is the fourth reason, and it is not a defence. If your family shows no deviation, write exactly that down; it is a finding, too.

Add screenshots where they carry your argument. **AI as sparring partner is allowed** (naming checks: *"What is this pattern called?"*), but the verdicts must be yours.

Fourth assignment (45 minutes): Bring the two halves of this sheet together in your team. Put the four family dissections and the checked claims side by side and discuss the following guiding questions:

- Where does the app break a pattern, and does any of the checked claims support the break as an intentional decision?
- Which of the four verdicts (*innovation / error*) would change if the shakiest claim turned out to be unsupportable?
- Which claim would the vendor have to support with evidence before you would copy this app's pattern break in your own project?

Condense your discussion into a one-page team profile of the app: the strongest evidence-backed statement you can make about it, the shakiest claim that surrounds it, and the one pattern decision you would defend in front of a client, with a source.

Keep your claim check, your family dissection and the team profile, marked with the team's names. Exercise sheet 02 returns to the same app, and the claim check is the evidence discipline that Parts A, B and C and the seminar paper ask of every number you use.

Part A: this sheet in 15 minutes

The results of this sheet are the content of Part A, the first graded part of the presentation (20 points): 15 minutes in your team with the lecturer. Upload your presentation by **Fri 23 Oct**; you present it in **Exercise U2** (26 Oct for MUXP.1, 2 Nov for MUXP.2). The fifteen minutes carry what assignments 1 to 4 produced:

- **The app** and the market claims that surround it (assignment 1).
- **Each member's claim check:** the source chain to the oldest origin you reached, the verdict argued along measurer, year and population, and the flip condition (assignment 2).
- **Each family dissection:** the dominant pattern with its source, the recognition feature, and the deviation with verdict and price – or the finding that there is none (assignment 3).
- **The team profile:** the strongest evidence-backed statement about the app, the shakiest claim around it, and the one pattern decision you would defend in front of a client, with a source (assignment 4).

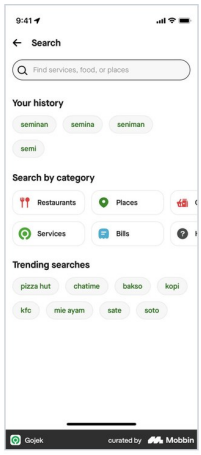
After Part A, this sheet stays in play: it counts again in **Part C**, the final presentation, where the whole exercise track U1–U5 is relevant, and it goes into your **seminar paper**, as all five sheets do.

Appendix: Pattern cards from Topic 2

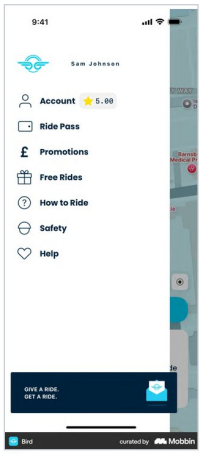
These twelve cards are screens of real apps, taken from this course's 2025 slide sets; eleven of them were curated by Mobbin. In the lecture, each team named one set of three. For each card: which pattern, which family – recognized by what? Name them before you read the answer key at the end of this appendix.

Set 1 · cards 1 to 3

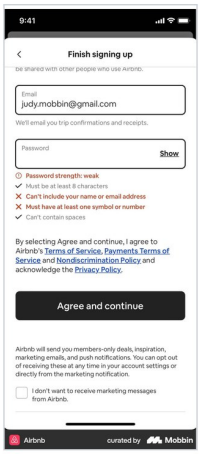
Card 1 · Gojek



Card 2 · Bird



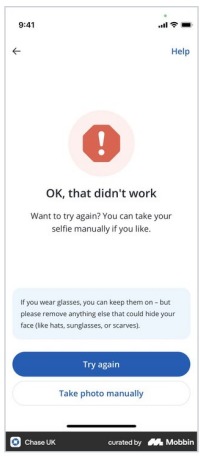
Card 3 · Airbnb



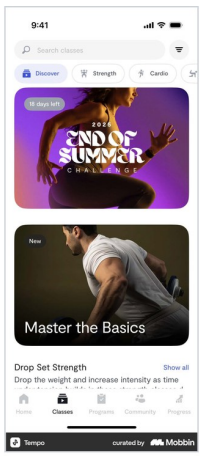
- **Card 1 · Gojek.** A search screen before the first keystroke: the search field on top, below it "Your history", "Search by category" and "Trending searches".
- **Card 2 · Bird.** A panel with the user's name and the entries Account, Ride Pass, Promotions, Free Rides, How to Ride, Safety and Help covers most of a map.
- **Card 3 · Airbnb.** "Finish signing up": under the password field, the rules ("Must be at least 8 characters" and others) get ticks and crosses while the user types, topped by "Password strength: weak".

Set 2 · cards 4 to 6

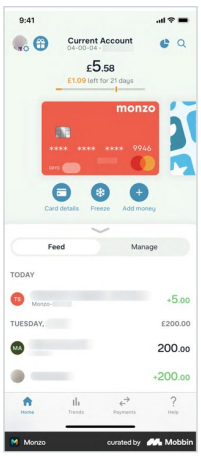
Card 4 · Chase UK



Card 5 · Tempo



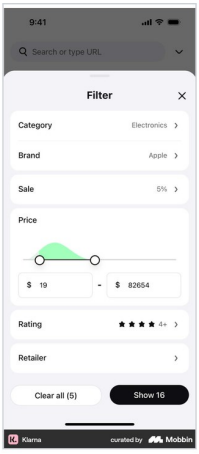
Card 6 · Monzo



- **Card 4 · Chase UK.** A full screen "OK, that didn't work" with an offer to take the selfie manually, a hint about glasses and hats, and two buttons: "Try again" and "Take photo manually".
- **Card 5 · Tempo.** A field "Search classes", directly below it the chips "Discover", "Strength" and "Cardio", then large content tiles.
- **Card 6 · Monzo.** An account screen with balance and card, a switch "Feed / Manage" above the transactions, and a row of icons with labels at the bottom edge.

Set 3 · cards 7 to 9

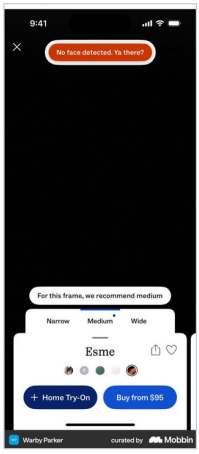
Card 7 · Klarna



Card 8 · Forest



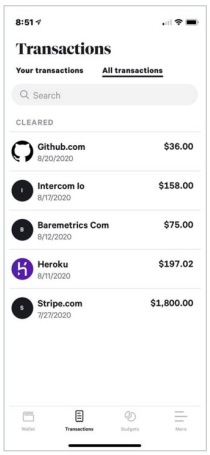
Card 9 · Warby Parker



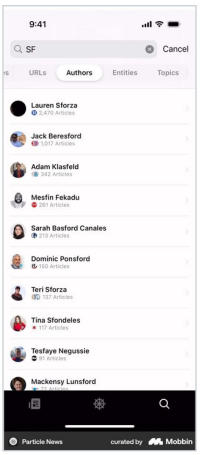
- **Card 7 · Klarna.** A sheet titled "Filter" over a product list: category, brand, sale, price range, rating and retailer; at the bottom "Clear all (5)" and "Show 16".
- **Card 8 · Forest.** A sign-in screen: email, a password field with an eye icon, the button "Sign In", the link "Forgot password?" and above them "Don't have an account? Sign up".
- **Card 9 · Warby Parker.** A virtual try-on in the camera view; at the top a short red notice "No face detected. Ya there?", below it the frame "Esme" with "Home Try-On" and "Buy from $95".

Set 4 · cards 10 to 12

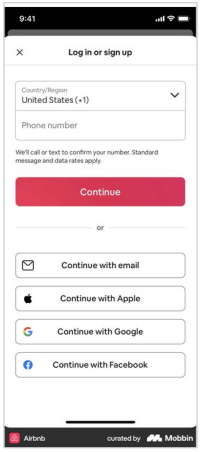
Card 10 · finance app



Card 11 · Particle News



Card 12 · Airbnb



- **Card 10 · finance app, not named.** A screen "Transactions" with the switches "Your transactions" and "All transactions", below them a search field and a list of payments dated 2020.
- **Card 11 · Particle News.** A search for "SF" with the tabs URLs, Authors, Entities and Topics above the results; Authors is selected and lists people with their article counts.
- **Card 12 · Airbnb.** "Log in or sign up": country and phone number in one form, the button "Continue", then "Continue with email", Apple, Google and Facebook.

Answer key

Family · pattern · recognition feature · source in the MUXP slide sets 2025.

- **Card 1 · Gojek:** search · search screen with suggestions · history and trends appear before the first input · MUXP 03 Search, p. 7
- **Card 2 · Bird:** navigation · drawer · a side panel over a half-hidden map · MUXP 02 Navigation, p. 4
- **Card 3 · Airbnb:** forms · inline validation · ticks and crosses under the field while the user types · MUXP 04 Feedback & Affordance, p. 6. *Feedback is accepted too*, if the recognition feature is right. Forms reads the screen as a form checking its field, the way inline validation appears in family (B); feedback reads the ticks and crosses as the system answering while you type – the 2025 slide sat in the feedback set.
- **Card 4 · Chase UK:** feedback · error message with a way out · cause, tip and a second route "Take photo manually" · MUXP 04, p. 12
- **Card 5 · Tempo:** *contestable* – search (facets) or navigation (top tabs). The chips "Discover, Strength, Cardio" sit directly below the search field. Read them as facets and you see search; notice that they switch whole content areas and you see top navigation. The 2025 slide asked exactly this: "Faceted search or top nav?" (MUXP 03 Search, p. 25).
- **Card 6 · Monzo:** navigation · two levels · segments on top, a persistent bar at the bottom · MUXP 02, p. 18
- **Card 7 · Klarna:** search · filter · the result count on the button before you confirm · MUXP 03, p. 34

- **Card 8 · Forest:** forms · sign-in form · two fields, password can be shown, link "Forgot password?" · MUXP 07 Forms, p. 7
- **Card 9 · Warby Parker:** feedback · toast / status notice · the message sits on top of the camera image, no dialog · MUXP 04, p. 5
- **Card 10 · finance app:** *contestable* – search or filter/navigation. A search field below the switches "Your transactions / All transactions" (MUXP 03, p. 26, "Filter or search?"; the app is not named, the bookings are dated 2020). Does it search everything or filter the visible list? The screen does not answer that, and that is the point: the assignment depends on which user problem you consider primary.
- **Card 11 · Particle News:** search · faceted search · categories cut down the result set · MUXP 03, p. 19
- **Card 12 · Airbnb:** forms · combined log-in / sign-up · one field, then the system decides · MUXP 07, p. 29